

The Swedish Death Cleaning Workbook for Seniors - Printable Worksheets

Every worksheet from the book, one per page. Print as many copies as you need.

The Three Questions and the Four Piles

1. Do I use it? (In the last year; in the last season.)
2. Do I love it? (Pleasure, not guilt.)
3. Would anyone want this after me, and would it be a burden or a gift?

Keep - Give (to whom?) - Sell (only if truly worth it) - Let go

Fifteen minutes counts. Touch everything once. Out of the house the same week. Tell someone.

Worksheet 2.1 - Before you start

Why I am doing this (in my own words; read it on the hard days)	
Who I am doing it for (myself, and who else)	
The rooms in my home, in the order I will do them (easy first)	
The person I will tell, who will ask how it is going	
Where the give pile will go (which charity, which people)	
My "decide later" box, and its date three months from now	
My fifteen-minute time, most days (attached to what)	

Worksheet 1.1 - The storage checklist

Area	Done	What went	What stayed and why
Attic or loft			
Garage			
Shed (or wait for Week 6)			
Cupboard under the stairs			
Top of wardrobes			
Under beds			
Hall cupboard			
Boxes from the last move			
Other people's things (list them; ask them)			

Worksheet 1.2 - The four-pile tally, Week 1

Day	Minutes	Keep	Give (to whom)	Sell	Let go (bags / boxes)	Out of the house?
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						

Weekly review

Days I did fifteen minutes or more (out of 7)	
Bags and boxes that left the house	
The thing I was surprised to be glad to see go	
The thing I kept, and why	
One person I told, and what they said	
Next week's room, and my helper if I need one	

Worksheet 2.1 - The wardrobe checklist

Category	Done	Kept (number)	Given / sold / let go	Notes (what I noticed)
Coats and jackets				
Trousers, skirts				
Tops, shirts, jumpers				
Dresses, suits, "occasion" clothes				
Underwear, nightwear, socks				
Shoes and boots				
Bags, hats, scarves, belts				
Bed linen, towels				
Bedside drawers and dressing table				
Jewellery (the untangled and the broken; the rest waits)				

Worksheet 2.2 - The four-pile tally, Week 2

Day	Minutes	Keep	Give (to whom)	Sell	Let go	Out of the house?
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						

Weekly review

Days I did fifteen minutes or more	
Bags that left the house	
What the wardrobe looks like now (write it down; it matters)	
The item I could not let go of, and whether that is love or guilt	
Who the coat went to	
Next week's room	

Worksheet 3.1 - The kitchen and bathroom checklist

Area	Done	What went	Notes
Worktops (clear except what is used daily)			
Cupboard: crockery and glasses			
Cupboard: pans and bakeware			
Drawer: utensils and gadgets			
Drawer: the "everything" drawer			
Food cupboards and spices (dates)			
Fridge and freezer (dates)			
Under the sink			
Bathroom cabinet: medicines (to the pharmacy)			
Bathroom: toiletries, towels, the cupboard			

Worksheet 3.2 - The four-pile tally, Week 3

Day	Minutes	Keep	Give (to whom)	Sell	Let go	Out of the house?
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						

Weekly review

Days I did fifteen minutes or more	
Bags that left the house; medicines returned	
What is on the worktop now	
The gadget I finally admitted I would never use	
Did I use the good china?	
Next week: paper (gather every pile into one box first)	

Worksheet 4.1 - The paper checklist

Source of paper	Done	Shredded / recycled (bags)	Kept (what)
The bureau / desk			
The kitchen drawer			
The boxes from Week 1			
The filing cabinet or folders			
Carrier bags of paper			
Manuals and guarantees			
Cards and letters (read once; keep the few for Week 7)			
Cuttings, recipes, brochures			
The Important Papers folder made and labelled			
The list given to: _____			

Weekly review

Days I did fifteen minutes or more	
Bags of paper shredded or recycled	
The Important Papers folder: done / nearly / what is missing	
Who has the list	
What I found that I had forgotten (a policy, a pension, a letter)	
Next week: money and passwords (gather the account list first)	

Worksheet 5.1 - The money map

Account or policy	Provider	Reference (not the password)	Regular payments in/out	Keep / close / consolidate

Worksheet 5.2 - The digital checklist

	Done	Where the details are
Password manager or password book set up		
Phone PIN, computer login, email password recorded		
Legacy contacts set (phone, email, social media)		
Unused accounts and subscriptions closed / cancelled		
Photographs gathered, backed up, best ones named		
A person told where all of this is		
My wishes written, signed, dated, in the folder		

Weekly review

Sessions done	
Accounts closed; subscriptions cancelled (and what that saves a year)	
The password question: solved, or who I need to ask for help	
Photographs: gathered / named / album ordered	
Wishes: written, and who knows	
Next week: the identity things (books, hobbies, the shed)	

Worksheet 6.1 - Books, hobbies, shed and spare room checklist

Area	Done	Kept	Given (to whom)	Let go
Books: the shelves				
Books: in boxes and cupboards				
Hobby equipment (list each hobby)				
Musical instruments, sports kit				
The shed / workshop				
Garden tools and pots				
The spare room				
Other people's things (dates given; collected?)				

Worksheet 6.2 - The four-pile tally, Week 6

Day	Minutes	Keep	Give (to whom)	Sell	Let go	Out of the house?
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						

Weekly review

Days I did fifteen minutes or more	
Books that left; where they went	
The hobby I admitted was over, and where its tools went	
The spare room: what it is for now	
One thing I gave in person, and how that felt	
Next week is the photographs and the sentimental things: who will do it with me?	

Worksheet 7.1 - The sentimental checklist

Category	Done with (who)	Kept (where, labelled?)	Given (to whom)	Let go
Photographs: prints				
Photographs: albums, slides, negatives				
Letters, cards, diaries				
Jewellery and watches				
Heirlooms, china, silver, furniture				
Children's things (one box each)				
Gifts kept from duty				
Souvenirs and collections				
The throw-away box (made and labelled)				

Worksheet 7.2 - Who gets what

The thing	Its story (one line)	Who I have asked	Their answer	Given on	Noted in the folder

Weekly review

Afternoons done, and with whom	
Photographs: kept / given / let go (roughly)	
The heirlooms given, and the faces	
What nobody wanted, and what I decided	
The throw-away box: made	
Next week: the living room, the last box, and telling the family	

Worksheet 8.1 - The living room checklist and the last box

Area	Done	What went	What stayed
Shelves and ornaments			
Cupboards and drawers			
Magazines, DVDs, games			
Furniture (each piece)			
The "decide later" box opened			

Worksheet 8.2 - Finishing

The letter written, and in the folder	
The family told (who, when)	
The Important Papers list given to	
The Who Gets What sheet in the folder	
The throw-away box made	
Rooms done (out of ____)	
Bags, boxes and pieces of furniture that left the house over eight weeks (add up the tallies)	

Weekly review - and the eight-week review

What the house is like to live in now	
The three hardest things, and how I got past them	
The best thing I gave, and to whom	
What I would tell someone starting Week 1	
The one-in-one-out rule I will keep (Chapter 9)	
The date of my yearly check of the folder and the money map	

Worksheet 9.1 - My keeping rules

Rule	My version	Started
One in, one out		
The give bag (where)		
The daily reset (which surface, when)		
The gift rule (what I have told people)		
The yearly check (date)		
The seasonal pass (when)		

Worksheet 10.1 - The downsizing plan

The new home: rooms and rough sizes (drawing on a separate sheet)	
Furniture that has a place there	
Furniture that does not (given / sold / to whom)	
Rooms in the old house to clear completely	
Moving date, and the eight weeks / three months before it	
Helpers: who does what (decisions are mine; lifting and vans are theirs)	
The first-night box	
The goodbye to the old house (photos, a last walk round)	

Worksheet 11.1 - Where things go

Kind of thing	Where it goes near me (name, address, collection?)	Phone / website
Clothes, books, china, small items		
Furniture (collected)		
Tools		
Craft and hobby materials		
Coats, blankets, toiletries		
Electricals, batteries, paint, chemicals		
Medicines		
Antiques and valuables (auction / dealer)		
House clearance, if needed		

Blank room checklist

Area	Done	What went	What stayed and why

Blank four-pile tally

Day	Minutes	Keep	Give (to whom)	Sell	Let go	Out of the house?
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						

Blank weekly review

Days I did fifteen minutes or more	
Bags and boxes that left the house	
The thing I was glad to see go	
The thing I kept, and why	
Who I told	
Next week's room	

The twelve-week tracker

Week	Room	Days done (of 7)	Bags / boxes out	Notes
1	Storage			
2	Bedroom			
3	Kitchen and bathroom			
4	Paper			
5	Money and digital			
6	Books, hobbies, shed			
7	Sentimental			
8	Living room and the family			
9				
10				
11				
12				

Print more copies of every worksheet from the link at the front of the book.